Cinamitra

Master Document

The production team's central nervous system.
Built for Indian film. Starting with Telugu.

OLD SCHOOL STORYTELLERS · HYDERABAD

VERSION 2.0 · JUNE 2026

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PART ONE

Platform Vision

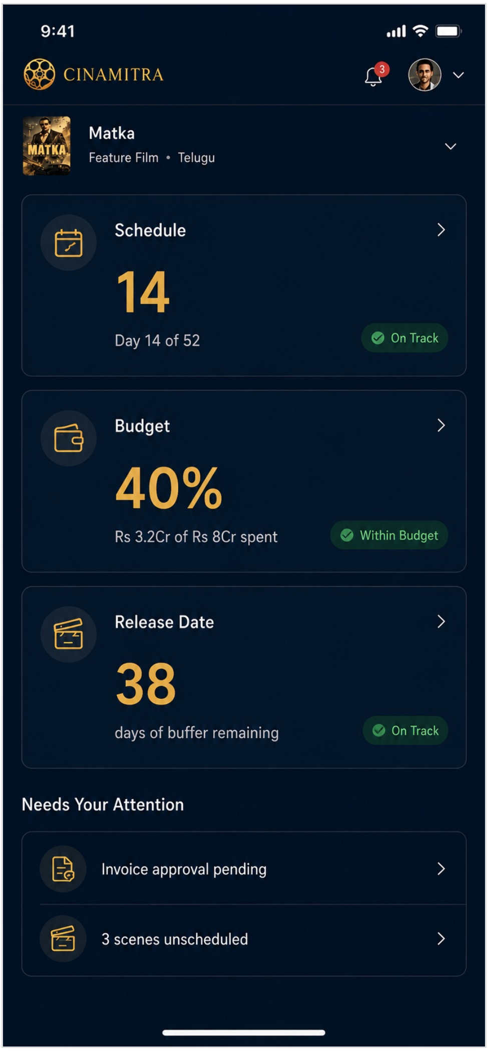
The production team's central nervous system

Core principle

Each role sees the production through their own lens. The data is shared. The view is personal.

Production is many people's work coordinated together. The producer makes financial and strategic decisions. The director makes creative decisions. The line producer manages operations and resources. The ADs run the day-to-day on set. The script supervisor holds continuity. Each department head carries their own concerns.

Cinamitra gives each role its own view of the same underlying data. The breakdown, schedule, budget, discussions, decisions all live in one place. Each role sees what serves their work and contributes what only they can contribute.



The producer's view: schedule status, budget consumption, and release-date buffer at a glance.

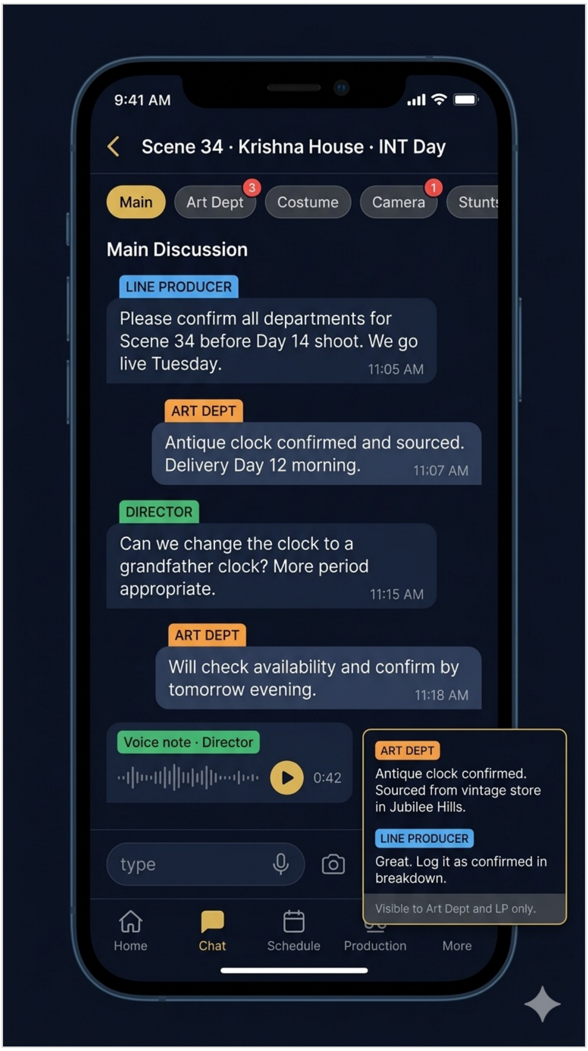
The scene is the unit of organization

Production conversations belong with the scene they are about. Not with the team that happens to be discussing them.

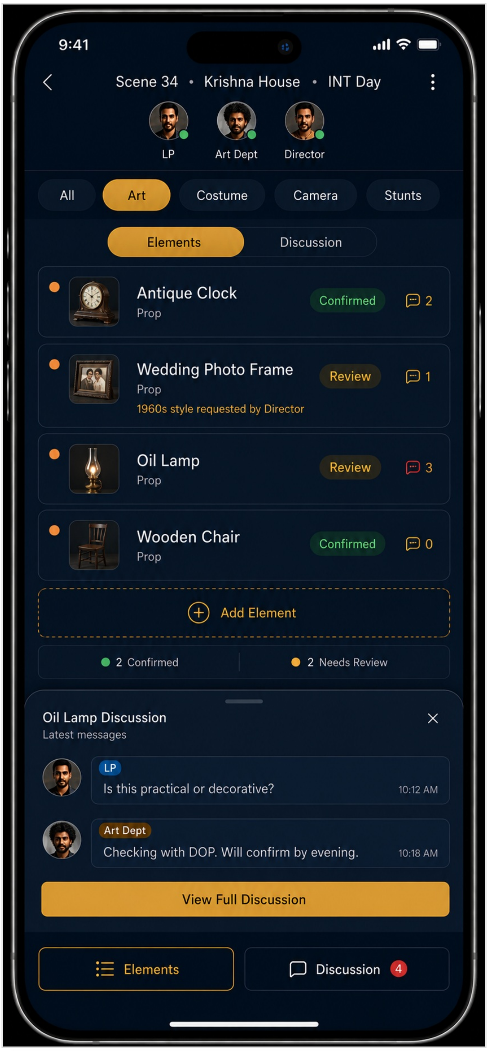
Indian production teams currently coordinate through five or more WhatsApp groups per production. The line producer's logistics group. The art department's prop group. The costume team's continuity group. The director's creative circle. The production office's vendor group. Decisions made in one group rarely propagate to the others. Context disappears. The same questions get asked three times. Critical information lives in someone's chat history and gets lost when WhatsApp auto-deletes media.

Cinamitra organizes conversation around the scene, not around the team. When the art department asks about a prop for scene 34, the question lives with scene 34. The director's approval lives with scene 34. The costume designer's continuity check lives with scene 34. The AD's logistics note lives with scene 34. The producer's pinned decision sits at the top of scene 34 as the canonical record of what was agreed.

Every breakdown element, schedule placement, budget line item, vendor relationship, and financial transaction also lives with the scene. Open scene 34 and see everything that touches that scene in one place. Months later, when the production has moved on, anyone can open scene 34 and reconstruct the full context.



Scene 34 discussion: department-tagged messages, voice notes, and a pinned summary. The conversation lives with the scene, not in a WhatsApp group that auto-deletes.



Same scene, element-side view: props with confirmation status, with discussion accessible per element.

This is more than a feature. It is the organizing architecture that makes the role-based views useful. Without scene-level organization, role-based views become disconnected dashboards. With scene-level organization, each role sees their concerns attached to specific scenes, and the scenes carry the full institutional memory of the production.

How roles work: base roles and responsibility modules

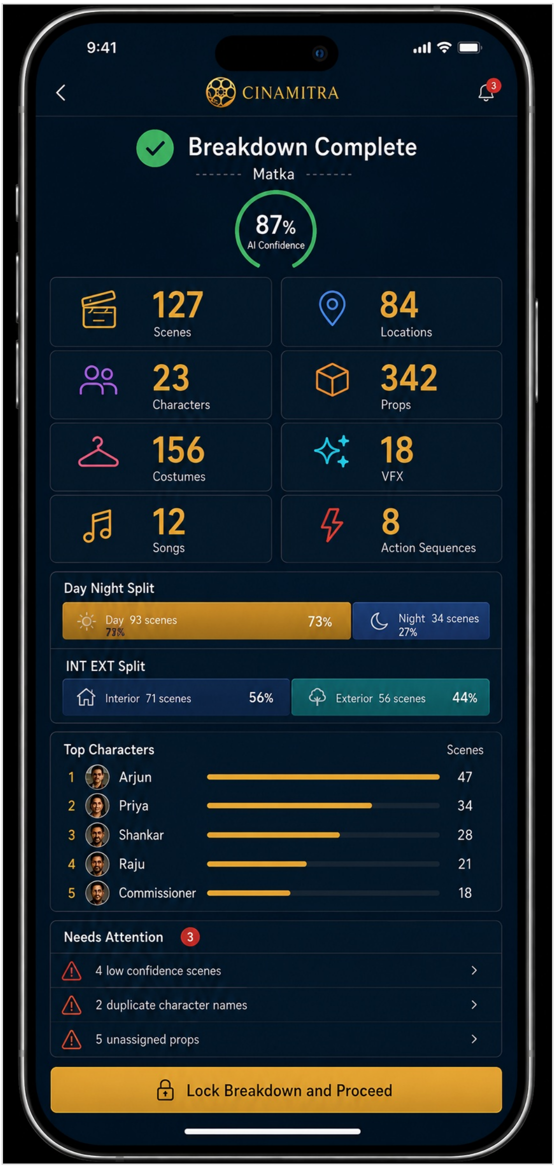
Cinamitra does not model people as a fixed list of job titles. It models a small set of base roles, and a set of assignable responsibility modules that attach to a person on a specific production. A person's view and permissions are composed from the modules they hold.

This reflects how crews actually divide work. An assistant director is not a single fixed view. One AD carries continuity. Another carries floor management. Another liaises with the art department. Each of them logs in and works their own piece. If only the senior AD had a login and had to enter everyone else's updates by walking around and asking, the platform would be more work than WhatsApp, not less. The work has to divide across the people who actually do it, each with their own login, each updating their own responsibility.

So responsibilities are modules, not roles. The continuity AD logs in and sees the continuity panel and can edit continuity reports. The wardrobe assistant logs in and updates costume status on their scenes. They share the AD base role but hold different modules, and their homepage is assembled from the modules they carry. Permissions ride on the module: holding the continuity module grants continuity editing, not budget editing. A person's total access is the union of their modules.

Two kinds of flexibility follow from this. Responsibilities are composable: a department head can divide work among assistants by assigning modules. And presence is phase-flexible: some roles attach only when a given film needs them. A VFX supervisor is embedded from pre-production on a VFX-heavy film and absent entirely on a small drama. A music director often comes in during pre-production for song composition. The platform supports a role being active across whatever phases a production requires, rather than hard-coding any role to a single phase.

> **Important scope note for the MVP.** The data model supports composable modules and phase-flexible roles from day one, so nothing has to be rebuilt later. But the MVP ships only two or three fixed modules (the line producer experience in full, the AD with continuity built in, and a read-only producer view). Full assignable-module flexibility, where any module can be assigned to any person and views assemble dynamically, is a Phase 1.5 deliverable. This keeps the MVP shippable in five to seven months while preserving the architecture for where the platform is going.



Fourteen roles across the data model. MVP ships five roles in full (Producer, Line Producer, Accountant, Cashier, Production Manager, AD); the remaining roles arrive in Phase 1.5 and Phase 2 on the same underlying data model.

Base roles

The platform's named base roles are: Director, Assistant Director, Camera (DOP), Art (Production Design), Costume, Production (Line Producer and Production Manager), Finance (Accountant and Cashier), Producer (including Executive Producer as a read-only tier), and Editor. External and specialist roles, added in later phases, include Vendor, Agent, Actor, VFX Supervisor, Music Director, Dub Engineer, and SFX. Each base role below describes the default view; on a real production, responsibility modules refine what each person sees and can edit.

Producer

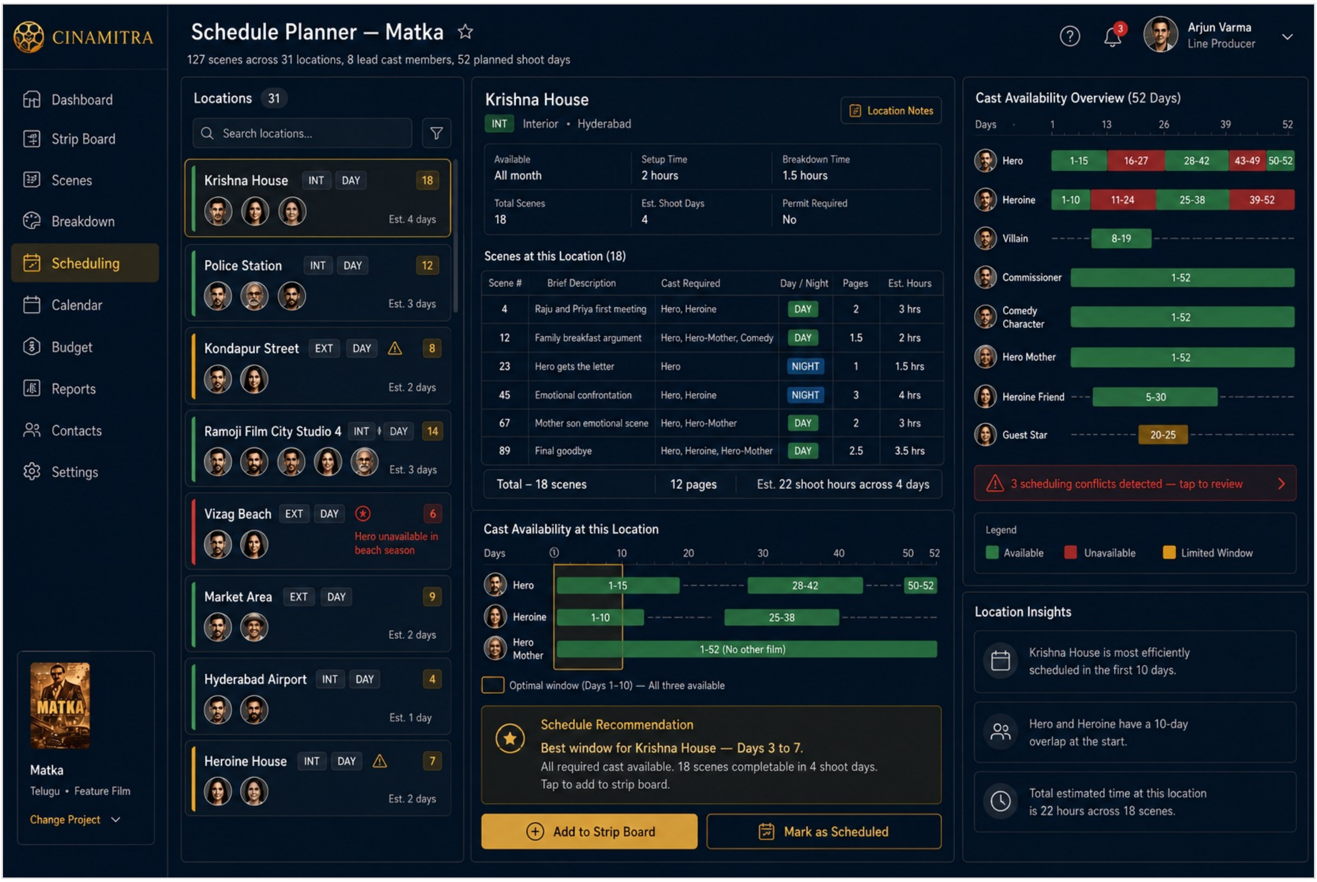
Budget tracking. Schedule status. Pending approvals. Variance from plan. Daily and weekly summary reports. Cross-production analytics for production houses doing multiple films. The producer does not see breakdown elements, continuity flags, or AD call sheet management by default. None of this is hidden if the producer wants to look. The default view is what serves the producer's job.

Director

Creative state of the production. Which scenes are locked. Which have revision requests. Which have continuity concerns. Which have casting decisions pending. Creative intent notes attached per scene. Performance notes. Visual references. Mood descriptions. Music or sound concepts. The director does not see vehicle assignments or vendor invoices. The director sees what serves the creative work. A different product experience than the line producer's view, on the same underlying scene data.

Line producer

Operational state. Breakdown completeness. Schedule conflicts. Department resource allocation. Budget tracking. Vendor management. The production manager's command view. The heaviest user during pre-production, which is why the desktop breakdown experience is designed around this workflow.

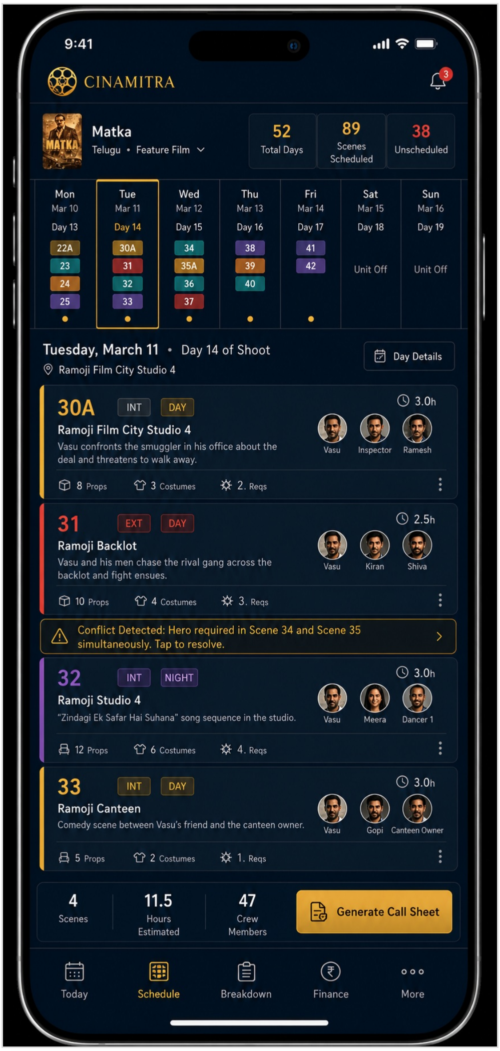


The line producer's planning surface: location-driven schedule with cast availability windows and conflict detection across the 52-day shoot. This is the core MVP wedge.

Assistant director

Mobile-first. Today's scenes. Today's call times. Today's actor arrivals. Today's open issues. Designed for someone on location, not at a desk. Scene revision capture with the phone camera. Voice notes to the line producer. Quick logging of issues.

The AD is the clearest example of the responsibility-module pattern. Continuity is an AD module, not a separate script-supervisor role, because on most productions the AD carries continuity rather than a dedicated person. The continuity AD edits continuity reports from the AD login. Other AD modules (floor management, art liaison, wardrobe coordination) attach to different ADs so the work divides across the people doing it. The MVP ships the AD with continuity built in; the rest of the modules arrive in Phase 1.5.



The AD on-set view: today's scenes with cast, props, costume counts, and conflict alerts. Designed for one-handed use on location.

Script supervisor / continuity

On most Telugu productions continuity is carried by an AD rather than a dedicated person, so continuity is an AD responsibility module rather than a standalone role. Where a production does run a dedicated continuity person, the same module is assigned to them directly. The work is the same: character appearance database, scene relationship maps, flagged inconsistencies, reference photos from previous shoots. The system surfaces what serves that work and flags continuity breaks automatically.

Cinematographer

Camera-related elements per scene. Lighting requirements. Equipment scheduled for each day. The director's visual intent notes for upcoming scenes. Technical and visual production reality.

Production designer

Props per scene. Locations per scene. Set construction status. Reference images attached by the director. Vendor relationships for art department needs.

Costume designer

Costumes per scene per character. Continuity requirements across scenes. Fittings scheduled. Vendor relationships. The thread of how a character's clothing evolves through the story, with continuity flags raised automatically when something does not match.

Actor (Phase 2)

Only their own scenes. Their call times. Their costume requirements. Their continuity notes. No visibility into budget or other actors' availability. Privacy preserved.

Editor (post-production)

Scene data carries forward to the edit. Shot lists, takes, and continuity notes per scene support assembly. A back-end role that activates at the post-production handover.

Phase-flexible and specialist roles

Some roles attach only when a given film needs them, across whatever phases that film requires. The VFX supervisor is embedded from pre-production on a VFX-heavy film, tagging which scenes need VFX, supervising plate and reference capture on set, and receiving shots in post; on a small drama the role is absent entirely. The music director often comes in during pre-production for song composition. Dub engineer and SFX are genuine post-production roles. Vendor and Agent are external roles added in Phase 1.5.

Architectural requirements

Role-based views must be built into the platform from day one. Retrofitting them later means rebuilding the foundation. This is the most important architectural decision.

The data model supports multiple views over the same underlying data. A scene has cast elements, props, costumes, locations, time of day, creative intent notes, continuity flags, schedule information, budget allocation. Different roles see different subsets, organized differently, with different actions available.

The permission system is granular. Not just role-based but project-role-based. Someone can be a director on one production and a freelance line producer on another. Permissions in each workspace differ. Privacy boundaries reflect the natural privacy that already exists in production.

The notification system is role-aware. The director gets notifications about creative decisions. The AD gets notifications about operational issues. The producer gets notifications about budget variance and approval requests.

The interface adapts fundamentally based on role. Not by hiding menu items. The director's homepage shows different content than the line producer's homepage. A director's Cinamitra and a line producer's Cinamitra should feel like related but different products.

What the platform unlocks

Positioning

Not a breakdown tool. Not a schedule tool. Not a budget tool. The platform where the entire production team coordinates, with each role's view designed for their work. The breakdown brings the line producer in. The schedule brings the AD in. The budget brings the producer in. The continuity tracking brings the script supervisor in. The creative dashboard brings the director in. Each role has an entry point and a reason to stay.

Network effects within a production

When the line producer uses Cinamitra alone, value is limited. When the director joins, the line producer's work integrates with creative decisions. When the AD joins, the production day workflow gets captured. When the script supervisor joins, continuity becomes systematic. Each role added increases value for every other role.

Pricing alignment

The production house pays for the workspace where all roles coordinate. Seat allocations match the team size for each tier. The production house captures the value of the entire team on one platform and pays for that platform. Unit economics work because each annual or per-film payment supports many users. See Part III for the full tier structure.

Compounding defensibility

Script corpus. Production database. Continuity database. Casting database. Cross-production analytics. Workflow stickiness across multiple roles. Each layer built up over time through real use by real production teams. The longer the platform runs, the more accumulated data and integration there is to protect the position.

MVP scope

Five to seven months. The line producer's experience ships fully. Breakdown editor. Schedule strip board. Export workflow. End to end. This is the wedge that brings the first beta productions onboard.

Post-breakdown summary: AI confidence, element counts, day/night split, and the items that need human attention before scheduling can begin.

The MVP architecture is built with role-based views as a first-class concept from day one. The data model supports multiple views. The permission system supports granular roles. The interface framework allows different homepages per role. The director's view, AD's view, script supervisor's view, and producer's view can be added in Phase 1.5 without architectural rework.

Two other roles ship in minimal form. Producer's dashboard with read-only visibility into the line producer's work. AD's mobile view, simplified, so the on-set workflow is sketched in. These establish Cinamitra as a platform from the first beta production, not just a line producer's tool.

Phase 1.5 scope

Seven expansions that make the platform thinking fully real:

- Multi-user collaboration with role-based permissions fully realized. The director's view, AD's view, script supervisor's view become first-class experiences.
- Scene-level discussion threads with @mentions and tagging. Coordination attached to scene data, with producer decisions pinned as institutional memory.
- Producer dashboard expanded. Real-time variance from plan. Daily and weekly summary reports. Pending approval queue. Cross-production analytics.
- Full budgeting module with Indian-format outputs. Lakhs and crores. Three-tier accommodation. Vendor categories specific to Indian production. Foundation for variance reporting.
- Mobile app for on-set workflows. iOS and Android. Designed for the AD's day on set. Scene revision capture. Voice notes. Daily production status. Producer notifications on mobile.
- Logistics layer. Vehicle and driver management. Department allocation per shoot day. Call sheets generated and

distributed via WhatsApp. Daily production reports.

- Vendor portal with operational context tagging. Vendors upload bills directly. Production manager tags each bill by shoot day, scene, or schedule block. Last-minute expenses traced to operational context. Variance analysis surfaces patterns across similar day types and locations.

PART TWO

Technical Specification

Architecture, data model, scope, and execution reference

Purpose

This part of the document is the technical reference for Cinamitra. It serves two audiences. The first is the technical co-founder who needs to understand the architecture, the data model, and the engineering decisions in enough depth to begin building. The second is the founder, for internal use as a single source of truth across the project's strategic, product, and execution dimensions.

1. Strategic context and market position

The opportunity

The Indian film industry produces over 1,800 feature films per year across Hindi, Telugu, Tamil, Kannada, Malayalam, Bengali, and other languages. Despite the scale, production management tooling for this industry is underdeveloped. Global tools like Filmustage, StudioBinder, and Movie Magic were built for Hollywood workflows and do not handle Indian production realities natively. Indian-specific tools like Studiovity have built broad feature sets but have not achieved scale.

The result is that the dominant coordination mechanism for Indian productions is WhatsApp, supported by Excel sheets, paper receipts, and verbal communication. This works at a basic level but produces predictable failures. Information gets lost. Decisions become disputed. Variance from plan is discovered late. The line producer becomes the bottleneck for everything.

The market shift

Two recent developments make this the right moment to build Cinamitra. First, AI-powered text understanding has reached a point where script breakdown can be automated meaningfully. Pre-trained large language models handle screenplay structure well, with prompting rather than custom training. The technical barrier that existed five years ago is gone. Second, the Indian film industry is professionalizing. Production houses are growing larger. OTT platforms are demanding more sophisticated reporting.

The competitive landscape

Filmustage offers AI-powered breakdown and scheduling but is built for American productions. Indian language handling is weak. Studiovity is an Indian player with broad pre-production features but small revenue and a separate-products architecture. StudioBinder is US-based with USD pricing and a call-sheet focus. Lorven AI Studio, backed by Dil Raju, announced four AI products for Telugu film production in May 2025 but public evidence suggests they have not shipped substantially.

The opening

Cinamitra's opportunity is the integrated platform that competitors have not built. Filmustage is breadth-of-one. Studiovity is breadth-of-many-separate-tools. Lorven AI is announcement-without-product. The first credible integrated platform that ships and accumulates customers captures relationships that take years to displace.

2. Product principles

Five principles anchor every product decision. These are non-negotiable design constraints.

Principle 1: Each role sees the production through their own lens

The data is shared. The view is personal. The director's Cinamitra and the line producer's Cinamitra should feel like related but different products built for the work each does.

Principle 2: The scene is the unit of organization

Production conversations belong with the scene they are about, not with the team that happens to be discussing them. Breakdown elements, schedule placement, budget line items, vendor relationships, financial transactions, and discussion threads all live with the scene.

Principle 3: One integrated workflow, not separate products

The breakdown becomes the schedule becomes the budget becomes the actuals becomes the reports. Cinamitra is one platform where data flows from each phase to the next automatically.

Principle 4: Financial operations run continuously from day one

Money flows from the moment the producer signs the deal, not from shoot day one. The accountant and cashier need to be tracking from day one of pre-production. Variance reporting is meaningful only when it covers the full production timeline.

Principle 5: People are modeled as base roles plus assignable responsibility modules

Cinamitra does not model people as a fixed list of job titles. It models a small set of base roles, and a set of assignable responsibility modules that attach to a person on a specific production. A person's view and permissions are composed from the modules they hold. This is the platform's organizing concept for people, and it applies across all departments, not just one. Responsibilities divide across the people who do them, each with a login, each carrying their own modules. Permissions ride on the module: a person's total access is the union of their modules.

3. Architecture overview

Cinamitra has a three-layer architecture. The creative workflow layer runs as a sequential conveyor belt through six stations. The financial operations layer runs continuously underneath. The producer's unified view sits above both layers, observing everything in real time.

Layer 1: Producer's unified view

The producer's dashboard sees the entire production at a glance. Budget status. Schedule progress. Pending approvals. Variance from plan. Creative state. Recent activity feed across all layers.

Layer 2: Creative workflow (six stations)

Station 1: Script and Breakdown

Primary roles: Line Producer, Director, Script Supervisor. Script imported in any Indian language or English. AI extracts scenes, cast, props, locations, costumes, time of day, and other production elements. Director adds creative intent notes per scene. Script supervisor flags continuity considerations.

Station 1 output: complete breakdown summary with element counts by department, cast scene distribution, and the production-insight cards that flag stunts, location permits, and items needing review.

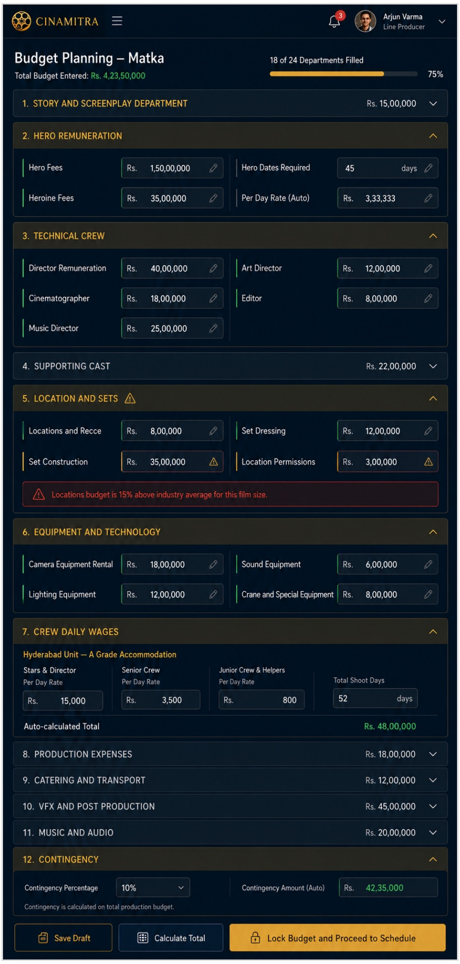
Station 2: Schedule Construction

Primary roles: Line Producer, AD, Director. Scenes arranged into shoot days. Strip board interface with drag-and-drop. Conflict detection across cast availability, location grouping, day-night considerations, equipment dependencies. Indian production specific patterns including song picturisation blocks and fight sequence staging.

Station 2: the strip board with scenes color-coded by location, lock/draft status per day, and a day-detail panel for the selected shoot day.

Station 3: Budget Plan

Primary roles: Line Producer, Producer, Accountant. Budget structure with hierarchical line items. Three basis types: FIXED, MONTHLY, VARIABLE. Schedule drives variable line items. Breakdown drives art and cast costs. Three-tier accommodation. Indian rupee formatting in lakhs and crores.



Station 3: department-level budget planning with completion tracking and variance flagging.

Station 4: Daily Operations

Primary roles: AD, Cashier, Production Manager, all crew. Today's scenes view for ADs on mobile. Cash transactions logged in real time by cashier with receipt photos. Daily expense sheet matching the operational reality of Indian productions. Scene-level discussions for coordination.

Station 5: Variance and Reports

Primary roles: Accountant, Line Producer, Producer. Actuals against plan computed continuously. Daily, weekly, and schedule-level summaries. Approval queue for producer signoff. Last-minute expenses traced to operational context through scene and day tagging.

Station 5: budget consumption per department, recent expenses, and on-track indicators.

Station 6: Post-Production Handover

Primary roles: Editor, Post Supervisor, Accountant. Scene data carries to post-production workflows. VFX scope identified from breakdown. Vendor invoices for post-production processed. Final settlement. Production database preserved for institutional memory.

Layer 3: Financial operations (four continuous tracks)

This layer runs from day one of pre-production to day final of post-production. Four tracks operate continuously: the Accountant (chart of accounts, vendor invoices, payroll, TDS/GST, source of truth for actuals), the Cashier (on-location cash, receipt photos, end-of-day reconciliation), Reimbursements (anyone who pays out of pocket), and the Vendor Portal (vendors upload bills, tagged by day/scene/schedule block).

Bidirectional workflow flow

The conveyor belt operates in both directions. Script-first productions flow forward. Commitment-first productions flow backward. Most productions are hybrid.

The linear model assumes script gets imported, then breakdown, then scheduling, then budgeting. This works for OTT commissioned content and director-driven productions. Mainstream Indian commercial cinema often operates in the opposite direction: a star agrees to a project based on a brief concept and gives committed dates. The film gets greenlit on the actor's commitment, not on a finished script. Production then works backwards. Cinamitra supports both flows natively.

This is genuinely differentiated from global tools. Filmustage, StudioBinder, and Movie Magic all assume a script-first workflow because that is how Hollywood typically operates. Cinamitra serving both flows is part of its competitive moat for Indian commercial cinema.

Value-driven budget calculation

The breakdown is the source of truth. The budget is a derived view with rates and aggregation applied. When breakdown changes, budget recalculates automatically. Three layers of value data feed the calculation: system defaults, production-specific overrides, and scene-specific overrides. This is standard application logic, not AI. The integration is the value, not magical intelligence.

Edit and revision cascade

When users edit something, the system handles downstream effects automatically. Drag a scene from day 18 to day 14 and the system updates the schedule, recalculates the budget for both days, checks cast and location availability and flags conflicts, updates equipment scheduling, notifies affected parties, and logs the change in the audit trail. Conflict detection uses standard application logic, not AI. Version history captures every change.

4. Data model and ownership architecture

The data model is the foundation that determines whether the platform thinking is achievable. Get this right and everything else becomes tractable.

Core entities

Workspace: top-level container representing a production house or independent producer's account. Contains multiple productions, billing relationship, and user memberships with role assignments.

Production: a single film, series, or commercial within a workspace. Has lifecycle status (development, pre-production, production, post-production, completed, archived).

Scene: the central organizing entity. Has scene number, INT/EXT, day/night, page count, description, location, schedule placement, status. Contains breakdown elements, creative intent notes, continuity flags, tagged transactions, and discussion threads. Every entity either belongs to a scene or references scenes.

Breakdown Element, Shoot Day, Budget Line Item, Financial Transaction, Vendor, User, and Discussion Thread complete the model. Financial transactions can be tagged with multiple scenes (a day's fuel supports several scenes), so the model supports many-to-many relationships between transactions and scenes.

Permission model

Permissions are project-role-based, not just role-based. A user's permissions in a production depend on workspace membership, role assignment in that specific production, and any explicit overrides. The same user can be a director on one production and a freelance line producer on another.

Data ownership architecture

Every meaningful field in the data model carries one of three ownership tags. This is a column-level decision set at the schema level, not configurable per workspace. The tagging is a day-one architectural commitment because retrofitting it onto an existing data set is genuinely painful.

Production-owned: the default. Data that describes the production itself, including budget figures, star fees, vendor rates, commercial terms, financier identities, and creative material. This data lives in the workspace and never leaves with a departing freelancer.

Person-owned: data that primarily describes a freelancer's own behavior, performance, or professional pattern. Examples for a line producer include average days from script-lock to schedule-lock, schedule slippage rate, response time to producer approval requests, conflict resolution time, and the fact of having worked with named vendors and crew. This data is portable with the person to future productions.

Shared (consent-gated): data with elements of both, where genuine professional value exists for the freelancer but the underlying figures are sensitive to the production. Vendor performance metrics with rates, crew rate ranges, and budget category estimation accuracy fall in this bucket. Default visibility is in-workspace only. Portability to a freelancer's personal layer requires explicit producer consent, set per metric, with a permanent audit record of the consent.

The architecture supports a dual-write path: every captured data point goes to the workspace-scoped store, and qualifying data also goes to a person-scoped layer keyed on user identity. The personal layer is invisible at MVP. It is exposed in Phase 1.5 as the foundation of an Individual Pro tier for freelancers carrying their professional record across productions. Building the foundation now costs design discipline; building it later costs a database migration and re-negotiated terms with existing customers.

> **Producer-side guarantee.** The pitch language to producers must be explicit: your production's confidential data stays in your workspace. Freelancers can carry their own professional performance metrics, the same way an editor tracks their delivery times. Star fees, budgets, specific vendor rates, and commercially sensitive figures stay with you and require explicit consent to ever leave. This guarantee is a contract, not a setting.

5. Role-based views and responsibility modules

Each role's experience is designed around what they actually do. The same underlying data is presented differently per role. Crucially, a role is a base identity, and responsibility modules assigned per production refine the view and permissions on top of it.

Base roles

The platform's named base roles are: Director, Assistant Director, Camera (DOP), Art (Production Design), Costume, Production (Line Producer and Production Manager), Finance (Accountant and Cashier), Producer (with Executive Producer as a read-only tier), and Editor. External and specialist roles added in later phases: Vendor, Agent, Actor, VFX Supervisor, Music Director, Dub Engineer, and SFX.

Responsibility modules and MVP scope

The data model supports composable modules and phase-flexible roles from day one, so nothing is rebuilt later. The MVP ships only two or three fixed modules: the line producer experience in full, the AD with continuity built in, and a read-only producer view, plus the accountant and cashier finance surfaces. Full assignable-module flexibility, where any module attaches to any person and views assemble dynamically, is a Phase 1.5 deliverable.

Per-role default views

Producer. Homepage shows financial and strategic state: budget status, schedule progress, pending approvals, variance over time, approval queue, and recent activity. Drill-down available into any metric.

Director. Homepage shows creative state: scenes locked, pending revisions, continuity flags, and a visual scene grid color-coded by status. Does not see vehicle assignments or vendor invoices by default.

Line Producer, AD, Script Supervisor, DOP, Production Designer, Costume Designer. Each gets a tailored homepage. The line producer is the heaviest pre-production user with the desktop breakdown and strip board. The AD is mobile-first for shoot days. The DOP sees camera elements, lighting, and equipment. The production designer sees props, locations, and set construction. The costume designer sees costumes per scene per character with automatic continuity flags.

Accountant. Desktop interface. Invoice queue, reimbursement queue, daily cashier reconciliation, chart of accounts mapped to Tally ledgers, budget vs actuals, and Tally export workflow. The accountant uses Cinamitra and Tally together: Cinamitra for operational financial workflow, Tally for formal accounting (TDS, GST, statutory reporting).

Cashier, Production Manager, Actor, Vendor, Agent, and specialist roles. The cashier is mobile-first with fast expense entry. The production manager runs logistics and can act as cashier or upload bills for vendors. Actors (Phase 2) see only their own scenes. Vendors get portal access to their own invoices (Phase 1.5). Agents (Phase 1.5) handle booking invitations on behalf of clients with strict fee privacy.

6. Financial operations layer

The financial operations layer is what separates Cinamitra from competitors. None of them handle the operational reality of money flowing through an Indian production over months of pre-production, production, and post-production.

The four tracks

Accountant track: active from day one of pre-production. Processes every invoice through any channel and maintains the source of truth. Cashier track: active from the first cash transaction, mobile-first, with end-of-day reconciliation. Reimbursement track: available to every team member with photo receipt capture and configurable approval thresholds. Vendor portal track: external vendors upload invoices that the production team tags with operational context.

Tally integration and compliance approach

Cinamitra is the operational layer. Tally remains the formal accounting system. The two integrate, they do not compete. Cinamitra exports approved transactions to Tally in structured formats; chart of accounts mapping is configured once per production house. This positioning is strategically important: production houses do not have to choose between Cinamitra and Tally. The accountant becomes a Cinamitra advocate precisely because it does not threaten what they do.

Export support

Every report supports export to both Excel and PDF. PDFs for sharing as final documents; Excel for working with data. This is non-negotiable in Indian business software.

7. AI components

AI is a feature that runs at specific moments in Cinamitra. It is not the core of the product. The core is the platform. AI adds specific capabilities at specific points where machine learning genuinely improves the experience.

Where AI is used

Script breakdown is the primary AI workload, using pre-trained LLMs with prompting. Primary script format for MVP is Tinglish (Telugu written in Roman script), the dominant format for working Telugu screenplays. Realistic accuracy at MVP launch: 75% on Tinglish, 80-85% on English. Pure Telugu script support is deferred to Phase 1.5. Other AI uses: continuity verification, variance pattern detection, smart categorization of vendor bills, and voice note transcription.

Where AI is not used

Most of Cinamitra runs on standard application logic. Budget calculations are deterministic arithmetic. Schedule conflict detection is conditional logic on structured data. Notification routing, permission control, data aggregation, workflow state management, and search are all rule-based and deterministic. The vast majority of daily user interactions do not involve AI calls.

Cost considerations

Estimated cost per full script breakdown: approximately ₹300 to ₹400 in API costs. A production with five revisions over pre-production might incur ₹500 to ₹800 total. The Crew Tier price of ₹15,000 per film, and the Starter Pack at ₹35,000 per year, easily cover these costs with healthy margin.

8. Engineering scope and timeline

MVP scope (5 to 7 months with one strong technical co-founder)

MVP focuses on the line producer's wedge with a read-only producer dashboard and simplified AD mobile. Features: script import and AI breakdown, breakdown editor with confidence flags, schedule construction with conflict detection, budget plan with three basis types, producer dashboard (read-only), AD mobile (today's scenes), cashier mobile, accountant invoice processing, reimbursement workflow, scene-level discussion threads, Indian rupee formatting, and PDF/Excel export.

Phase 1.5 scope (6-8 months after MVP)

With seed capital and 2-3 engineers: full multi-user collaboration across all roles, director and script supervisor workflows, the booking and negotiation layer, the vendor portal, expanded producer dashboard with cross-production analytics, full Tally integration, native mobile apps, the logistics layer, automated daily reports, and the Individual Pro tier surfacing person-owned analytics.

Phase 2 scope (12+ months after Phase 1.5)

With Series A: cross-production intelligence, casting database, actor portal, banking integration, real-time bidirectional Tally sync, predictive features, multi-language expansion beyond Telugu, and a white-label option.

Critical engineering decisions

Web platform: modern framework (React, Vue) for desktop. Mobile: PWA for MVP; cross-platform native (React Native or Flutter) for Phase 1.5. Backend: type-safe language (TypeScript, Go, Rust). Database: PostgreSQL with row-level security for multi-tenancy. AI: API-based with model-agnostic abstractions. File storage: object storage with CDN. Hosting: cloud with India presence (AWS Mumbai, Azure India, or GCP Mumbai). Real-time updates via WebSockets or server-sent events. Offline mobile support for remote locations.

9. MVP scope (detailed)

The MVP exists to validate that production houses will pay for Cinamitra. Validation does not require optimal feature completeness; it requires shipping something good enough that beta producers commit to using it.

MVP is successful if three production houses commit to using it for an active production through pre-production and at least one shoot schedule. Success is measured in customer commitment and observed usage, not features built.

MVP intentionally excludes: director's creative dashboard, script supervisor's continuity workflow, vendor self-upload, full Tally integration (basic CSV export only), banking integration, cross-production analytics, native app store release (PWA for MVP), Individual Pro surfaces, and languages beyond Telugu and English. These exclusions are deliberate.

10. Phase 1.5 scope (detailed)

Phase 1.5 begins after MVP launch with paying customers and seed capital, roughly 6 to 8 months with a team of 3 to 5. Goals: convert beta customers to paying, expand role coverage so the full team uses the platform, add the vendor portal as a key differentiator, ship native mobile apps, build foundations for cross-production analytics, and launch the Individual Pro tier surfacing person-owned analytics for freelancers carrying their professional record across productions.

11. Phase 2 and beyond

Phase 2 builds the deep moat: cross-production intelligence (after 50+ productions, unique data about Indian production patterns), a casting database, an actor self-service portal, banking integration, real-time bidirectional Tally sync, predictive budget estimation, multi-language expansion, and a white-label option for large production houses.

12. Business model

Cinamitra uses a six-tier pricing structure designed to match the actual buying patterns of the Indian film industry. The pricing is structured per-film and per-year rather than per-seat per-month, because that is how producers and line producers think about commitments. Full pricing detail with feature comparison is provided in Part III.

Pricing rationale at a glance

Per-film and per-year, not per-seat per-month. Indian producers commit budgets to films, not to ongoing software subscriptions. Pricing aligned to that window is easier to approve and easier to expense against a production budget.

Crew Tier as a bottom-up entry point. The Crew Tier at ₹15,000 per film is designed to be approvable by a line producer without producer signoff, which removes the single largest sales bottleneck.

Studio and OTT tiers for the actual ceiling. Studio Tier and OTT Tier reflect what production houses at scale actually spend on tooling, calibrated to houses doing 5-15+ films per year.

Capital requirements

Bridge round of ₹25-50 lakhs funds the MVP and the first beta cohort. Seed round of ₹2-4 crores funds Phase 1.5. Series A of ₹15-30 crores funds Phase 2.

13. Competitive landscape

Direct competitors: Filmustage (US, AI breakdown, weak Indian support, threat low-medium), StudioBinder (US, call-sheet focus, threat low), Movie Magic (legacy desktop, threat low), Studiovity (Indian, separate products, small revenue, threat medium), and Lorven AI Studio (Hyderabad, Dil Raju backing, announced but largely unshipped, high potential but low current threat).

Indirect competitors: WhatsApp and Excel (the real competition is the inertia of existing workflows), generic SaaS tools (Cinamitra's domain specificity is the moat), and generic accounting tools like Tally (Cinamitra integrates rather than replaces).

14. Open questions and decisions

Strategic: Telugu first (recommended) or pan-Indian. Production house focus (recommended for revenue) or freelancer focus (funnel). Target growing mid-tier production houses doing 2-5 films per year, with major houses (Mythri, Geetha Arts tier) as high-value parallel conversations.

Product: script supervisor priority (basic flagging in MVP, full workflow in Phase 1.5), VFX scoping (Phase 2), OTT-specific features (Phase 1.5), Individual Pro tier (Phase 1.5).

Technical: cloud-first (self-hosted evaluated in Phase 2), PWA for MVP then Android-first native, multi-provider AI abstraction, data ownership tagging from day one.

15. Execution priorities

This week: register domains, set up email, prepare for the technical conversation, send producer pitches, begin trademark search.

Next 30 days: convert a producer to beta commitment, identify and progress the technical co-founder, set up landing page and company page, refine the financial model.

Next 60-90 days: secure technical co-founder, close bridge round, begin MVP development, sign three beta agreements, set up legal structure.

Next 6-12 months: ship MVP, onboard beta productions, close seed round, begin Phase 1.5.

> **Honest reality check:** most pre-seed startups slip timelines by 50 to 100%. The bottleneck is not features. The bottleneck is conversations: producers who commit to beta, a technical co-founder who commits to building, investors who commit to capital. The materials are ready. The architecture is sound. What remains is the conversations.

PART THREE

Pricing & Tier Structure

Six tiers, designed for how Indian films actually buy

Tier overview

Tier	Price	Films	Seats	Primary buyer
Free	**₹0**	3 breakdowns	1 account	Any filmmaker — funnel entry
Crew Tier	**₹15,000/film**	1 film, 90-day window	10	Line producer or crew, no producer needed
Starter Pack	**₹35,000/year**	1 film/year	15	Production house with one film per year
Growth Tier	**₹65,000/year**	2 films/year	25	Active mid-tier production house
Studio Tier	**₹1,20,000/year**	5 films/year	50	Major production houses, large OTT studios
OTT Tier	**₹3,00,000+/year**	15+ or unlimited	Unlimited	High-volume OTT, ad film, microdrama studios
Institute Plan	**₹500/student/year**	Educational	Per institute	Film schools — pipeline play

Tier details and feature progression

Free

Who: any filmmaker with a script. Writer, director, producer. **What:** three full AI breakdowns per account, watermarked PDF export, all element categories, scene-level language auto-detection. **Purpose:** the wow moment. The user sees what Cinamitra does to a script in minutes versus weeks of manual breakdown work. Conversion to Crew Tier is the next step after the third breakdown.

Crew Tier — ₹15,000 per film

Who: line producers, ADs, or any crew member who needs to run one film through pre-production and shoot. No producer involvement required to start. **What:** everything in Free, plus unlimited breakdowns and revisions, full strip board scheduling, department-level budgeting, cashier expense logging, all role logins (LP, AD, Accountant, Cashier, Dept Heads, Mestri), attendance marking, today-view for AD on mobile, full scene discussions with departmental tabs, voice notes and file attachments, and unbranded PDF export. **Limits:** 1 film, 90-day active window, 10 seats. **Upgrade trigger:** need invoice approval workflow, producer dashboard, or variance reports; or production extends past 90 days.

Starter Pack — ₹35,000 per year

Who: production house committing to one film per year. **What:** everything in Crew Tier, plus invoice approval workflow, expense approval workflow, vendor directory with GST and bank details, full producer dashboard with health indicators and approval queue, daily auto-generated production reports, budget variance reports and alerts, schedule adherence reports, attendance summaries, executive producer read-only access, and same-day support. **Limits:** 1 film per year (no 90-day cutoff), 15 seats. **Upgrade trigger:** second film needed, or want vendor portal, batta automation, and production savings report.

Growth Tier — ₹65,000 per year

Who: active mid-tier production house doing 2 films per year. **What:** everything in Starter, plus vendor portal where vendors submit their own invoices, quote comparison across vendors, vendor advance management, TDS and GST auto-calculation, Tally-compatible export, scene-level financial tagging, three-tier accommodation tracking, batta invoice auto-generation, FEFSI union rate card configuration, overtime detection, multi-star constraint scheduling, actor availability calendar, commitment-first workflow, production savings report at wrap (shareable card), cross-production analytics (compare Film 1 vs Film 2), department cost patterns across productions, vendor reliability scoring, crew carry-over, and weekly auto-generated reports. **Language:** Telugu native script, Tamil and Tanglish (Phase 1.5). **Limits:** 2 films per year, 25 seats. **Saves ₹5,000** compared to two Starter Packs. **Upgrade trigger:** third film, or all Indian languages plus API access.

Studio Tier — ₹1,20,000 per year

Who: major production houses (Mythri-tier), large OTT studios. **What:** everything in Growth, plus up to 5 concurrent productions, cross-production financial comparison across all 5 films, cross-production schedule view in one calendar, all Indian languages (Hindi, Tamil, Kannada, Malayalam, Bengali), API access for custom integrations, investor and stakeholder report generation, and dedicated support contact. **Limits:** 5 films per year, 50 seats. **Saves ₹42,500** compared to 2.5x Growth Tier.

OTT Tier — ₹3,00,000+ per year

Who: Aha, ETV Win production partners, ad film studios, Dashverse-type microdrama companies. **What:** everything in Studio, plus 15+ films per year base or fully unlimited (custom priced), unlimited seats, dedicated account manager, custom onboarding, SLA guarantees, quarterly business reviews, priority feature requests, white-label option, custom NLP fine-tuning, deep Tally integration, custom ERP integrations, bulk data export.

Institute Plan — ₹500 per student per year

Who: film schools and colleges. **What:** full AI breakdown educational version, basic scheduling, scene discussions, institute admin dashboard. Watermarked exports. Non-commercial use only. **Purpose:** pipeline play, not revenue. Students who learn Cinamitra in school bring it to their first productions.

Upgrade math and unit economics

The upgrade ladder

Crew Tier to Starter Pack: ₹20,000 more. Not a saving; a feature upgrade. Starter adds invoice approvals, producer dashboard, variance reports, no 90-day limit, and same-day support. Worth the upgrade for any serious production house.

Starter Pack to Growth Tier: saves ₹5,000 versus two Starter Packs (₹70,000 to ₹65,000), and adds batta automation, Tally export, vendor portal, production savings report, cross-production analytics, multi-star scheduling, and 25 seats. The math favors Growth for any house doing two films.

Growth Tier to Studio Tier: saves ₹42,500 versus 2.5x Growth Tier (₹1,62,500 to ₹1,20,000), and adds 5 concurrent films, all Indian languages, API access, dedicated support, and 50 seats. The math strongly favors Studio for houses at the 5-film level.

Studio Tier to OTT Tier: ₹3 lakhs versus 2.5x Studio (₹3 lakhs). Roughly even on price; justified by unlimited films, unlimited seats, dedicated account manager, white label, and SLA guarantees.

Unit economics

AI cost per breakdown is estimated at ₹300-400. A production typically runs three to five breakdowns over pre-production, so AI cost per production is roughly ₹500-2,000. Against this, Crew Tier nets ₹13,000+ per film, Starter Pack nets ₹33,000+ per year, and Growth Tier nets ₹63,000+ per year, all comfortably margin-positive even at MVP cost structures.

Illustrative revenue path

Year 1 (validation): 5-10 paying houses, mix of Crew Tier and Starter Pack, ₹3-8 lakhs ARR. Year 2 (product-market fit): 30-50 houses, mix shifts toward Starter and Growth tiers, ₹15-35 lakhs ARR. Year 3 (scale): 100+ houses, increasing share of Growth and Studio tiers, ₹1-2 crores ARR. These are targets, not forecasts; the bottleneck is conversations and adoption, not capacity to serve.

Feature comparison matrix

Feature	Free	Crew	Starter	Growth	Studio	OTT
BREAKDOWN						
AI Breakdown (Tinglish, English)	✓ (3 only)	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Department collaboration	—	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Clean unbranded PDF export	—	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Telugu native script	—	—	—	✓	✓	✓
All Indian languages	—	—	—	—	✓	✓
SCHEDULING						

Strip board and call sheets	—	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Release date backward scheduling	—	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Multi-star constraint engine	—	—	—	✓	✓	✓
Actor availability calendar	—	—	—	✓	✓	✓
BUDGETING AND FINANCE						
Budget planning and expense logging	—	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Invoice approval workflow	—	—	✓	✓	✓	✓
Vendor portal (vendor self-submit)	—	—	—	✓	✓	✓
Batta invoice automation	—	—	—	✓	✓	✓
Tally-compatible export	—	—	—	✓	✓	✓
TDS and GST auto-calculation	—	—	—	✓	✓	✓
PRODUCER OVERSIGHT						
Producer dashboard	—	—	✓	✓	✓	✓
Budget variance reports and alerts	—	—	✓	✓	✓	✓
Production savings report at wrap	—	—	—	✓	✓	✓
Cross-production analytics	—	—	—	✓	✓	✓
Investor / stakeholder reports	—	—	—	—	✓	✓
PLATFORM AND SUPPORT						
Active window	—	90 days	No limit	No limit	No limit	No limit
Films per year	3 BDs	1 film	1/yr	2/yr	5/yr	15+
Seats	—	10	15	25	50	∞
Support response	—	WhatsApp	Same day	Same day	Dedicated	Manager
API access	—	—	—	—	✓	✓
White label	—	—	—	—	—	✓